MODULE 42 · FOUNDATIONS - ALL DOMAINS

Confusion pairs

Around fifty pairs of terms the exam uses to tempt you, each told apart in one line, grouped by theme, with eight scenarios on the most dangerous.

DOMAIN Cross-domain EXAM WEIGHT All domains MODULE 42 of 49

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Most wrong answers are right answers to a different question.

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How to use this module

- Read each pair's one-line difference, then cover it and test yourself.
- In a question, find the **detail** that decides which half applies: identified or not, before or after, who owns it.
- When two options feel equally right, check whether they are the two halves of a pair.
- Each pair points back to the module that taught it, if you need the fuller story.

> ON THE EXAM
>
> The deciding detail is usually in the scenario's second sentence. Read for it deliberately.

Who owns what

ROLE	OWNS
Sponsor	The business case, funding, and decisions beyond the PM's authority
Product owner	The product backlog order and what the product should do
Project manager	Delivery of the project within delegated authority, and integration
Scrum master	The Scrum process, coaching, and removing impediments
Functional manager	People and resources in their department, and their priorities
PMO	Standards, support, reporting, and sometimes control of projects

ON THE EXAM

Many answers turn on sending the decision to its owner. Backlog order: product owner. Business case: sponsor.

People and leadership

PAIR	THE DIFFERENCE IN ONE LINE
Task or relationship conflict	About the work, and healthy; or about the people, and harmful (11)
Collaborate or compromise	Meet both sides' real needs; or each gives something up, when time is short (11)
Smoothing or withdrawing	Play down differences to calm things; or step back and postpone (11)
Consensus or unanimity	Everyone can support it; or everyone actively agrees (10)
Explicit or tacit knowledge	Can be written down; or lives in people, moved by working together (16)
Servant or directive leadership	Remove obstacles and grow the team; or tell people what to do, for crises (06)

ON THE EXAM

The number after each line is the module that taught it.

Stakeholders and communication

PAIR	THE DIFFERENCE IN ONE LINE
Push or pull communication	Sent to specific people; or placed for people to fetch (14)
Interactive or push	Live exchange that confirms understanding; or delivery only (14)
Acknowledgement or understanding	'I got it'; or 'I understood it'. Neither means agreement (14)
Requirements or expectations	Stated and agreed; or often unstated assumptions (13)
Engagement plan or communications plan	Changing involvement and support; or moving information (13)
Internal or external customer	Inside the organisation, such as operations; or outside it (13)

ON THE EXAM

When understanding must be confirmed, interactive beats push. When a customer is unhappy despite requirements met, look for expectations.

Scope and value

PAIR	THE DIFFERENCE IN ONE LINE
Product or project scope	What is delivered; or all the work to deliver it (18)
Validate or control scope	Customer accepts deliverables; or managing changes to the baseline (18)
Definition of ready or done	Fit to start an iteration; or fit to count as finished (19)
Acceptance criteria or definition of done	Specific to one story; or applies to every item (19)
MVP or MMF	Smallest thing to learn from; or smallest thing of value on its own (20)
Output or outcome	What the project produces; or the change it causes (01, 20)

ON THE EXAM

Validate scope needs the customer; control scope needs the baseline. Acceptance criteria are per story; the DoD is for all.

Quality

PAIR	THE DIFFERENCE IN ONE LINE
Quality or grade	Meets requirements; or a level of features (28)
Manage or control quality	Checks the process; or checks the product (28)
Inspection or audit	Examines a deliverable; or examines whether processes are followed (28)
Control or specification limits	What the process normally does; or what the customer requires (28)
Conformance or non-conformance costs	Spent to get it right; or lost because it went wrong (28)
Internal or external failure	Found before release; or found by the customer, and costliest (28)

ON THE EXAM

Is the team following its process? Audit. Is this deliverable right? Inspection.

Schedule and estimating

PAIR	THE DIFFERENCE IN ONE LINE
Effort or duration	Work required; or calendar time it takes (21)
Crashing or fast tracking	Add resources, more cost; or overlap activities, more risk (22)
Levelling or smoothing	Can move the end date; or stays within float (22)
Total or free float	Slip without delaying the project; or without delaying the next activity (22)
Mandatory or discretionary dependency	Required by the work; or chosen, so can be overlapped (22)
Analogous or parametric	From one similar project; or from a unit rate times quantity (21)

ON THE EXAM

Money but no risk appetite: crash. Risk appetite but no money: fast track.

Cost and finance

PAIR	THE DIFFERENCE IN ONE LINE
Contingency or management reserve	Identified risks, in the baseline; or unforeseen, outside it (26)
Cost baseline or budget	Estimates plus contingency; or plus management reserve too (26)
Cost or schedule variance	EV minus AC; or EV minus PV. Negative is bad (27)
Typical or atypical EAC	Performance continues: BAC / CPI; or a one-off: AC + (BAC - EV) (27)
Sunk or opportunity cost	Already spent, ignore it; or value of the best option not chosen (20, 26)
Fixed price or cost-reimbursable	Seller carries cost risk; or buyer does (24)

ON THE EXAM

Identified risk occurs: contingency. Nobody foresaw it: management reserve, through change control.

Risk and issues

PAIR	THE DIFFERENCE IN ONE LINE
Risk or issue	Might happen; or is happening (35)
Planned response or workaround	Prepared for an identified risk; or improvised for a surprise (35)
Contingency or fallback plan	What to do if the risk occurs; or if the contingency fails (37)
Residual or secondary risk	Left after the response; or created by the response (37)
Transfer or mitigate	Someone else bears the impact; or reduce probability or impact (37)
Exploit or enhance	Make sure the opportunity happens; or make it more likely (37)
Appetite or threshold	General attitude to risk; or a number that triggers action (36)

ON THE EXAM

Risk occurred and a plan exists: use it. Contingency failed: fallback. Response made a new risk: secondary.

Governance, change and closure

PAIR	THE DIFFERENCE IN ONE LINE
Process asset or environmental factor	Our own, usable and updatable; or a condition to work within (31)
Portfolio or programme	Chooses the right work; or coordinates related projects (31)
Change request or backlog item	Changes a baseline; or product change inside the boundary (34)
Change log or configuration management	Requests and decisions; or which versions are current (34)
Lessons register or repository	This project's lessons; or the organisation's (16)
Phase or project closure	A checkpoint and decision; or the end (30)

ON THE EXAM

Agile product change inside budget and date: backlog. Baseline, budget or contract: change request.

Agile, charts and change

PAIR	THE DIFFERENCE IN ONE LINE
Sprint review or retrospective	Inspect the product with stakeholders; or improve how the team works (04)
Product or sprint backlog	Everything the product might need; or this sprint's plan (04)
Burndown or burnup	Work remaining, hides scope change; or work done and total scope (29)
Velocity or capacity	Points actually completed; or time available this iteration (04, 21)
Scrum or Kanban	Fixed sprints and roles; or continuous flow with WIP limits (04, 05)
Change or transition	What happens outside, on a date; or what people go through inside (39)

ON THE EXAM

Stakeholders inspect the product at the review. Only the team improves its process at the retrospective.

> On an agile project, a senior marketing manager asks the project manager to move her feature to the top of the product backlog for the next sprint.
>
> The team has a product owner.

What should the project manager do?

A Reorder the backlog, since the request comes from a senior stakeholder.

B Direct her to the product owner, who owns the backlog order.

C Ask the sponsor to decide the backlog order.

D Ask the development team to vote on the order.

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should the project manager do?

A PM reorders.

Takes the product owner's decision. Seniority does not transfer ownership.

B Send her to the product owner.

The product owner owns the backlog order.

C Sponsor decides.

The sponsor owns the business case, not day-to-day backlog order.

D Team votes.

Developers own how, not what order the product is built in.

THE PAIR

Pair: product owner or project manager. Backlog order belongs to the product owner.

> A story has been tested, reviewed and integrated, and it meets the team's definition of done. At the sprint review, the product owner rejects it, because it does not show the discount rules the story's acceptance criteria require.
>
> A developer argues it should count as done.

Which statement is correct?

A Meeting the definition of done is enough for the story to be accepted.

B Meeting the acceptance criteria is enough, even without the definition of done.

C The definition of done and acceptance criteria are the same thing.

D The story must meet both: the definition of done for all items, and its own acceptance criteria.

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

Which statement is correct?

A DoD is enough.

The DoD is a general quality bar; it cannot know this story's rules.

B Criteria are enough.

Without the DoD, quality standards are skipped.

C They are the same.

One applies to every item; the other to one story.

D Both are needed.

DoD for quality on every item; acceptance criteria for this story's behaviour.

THE PAIR

Pair: definition of done or acceptance criteria. Every story needs both.

> A control chart shows a machining process with all points randomly spread within its control limits. However, about one part in five falls outside the customer's specified tolerance.
>
> The line manager says the process is 'in control, so there is no problem'.

Which statement is correct?

A. The process is stable, but not capable of meeting the specification; it needs improving.

B. The process is out of control and must be investigated for a special cause.

C. The control limits should be moved to match the customer's specification.

D. There is no problem, because the process is in control.

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

Which statement is correct?

A Stable but not capable; improve it.

In control is not the same as meeting the customer's specification.

B Out of control.

No point is outside the control limits and there is no run. It is stable.

C Move the control limits.

Control limits come from the process data, not from the customer.

D No problem.

One part in five fails the customer's requirement.

THE PAIR

Pair: control limits or specification limits. Stable is not the same as good enough.

> An activity is delayed by three days. The schedule shows it has five days of total float and one day of free float.
>
> The project manager is explaining the effect to the team.

What is the effect of the delay?

A The project finish date is delayed by three days.

B There is no effect on any other activity or on the finish date.

C The finish date is not affected, but the next activity's early start is delayed by two days.

D The project finish date is delayed by two days.

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What is the effect of the delay?

A Finish delayed three days.
Ignores the five days of total float.

B No effect on anything.
Ignores free float: only one day before the successor is affected.

C Finish safe; successor two days later.
3 is within total float 5; 3 minus free float 1 = 2 days for the successor.

D Finish delayed two days.
Applies the free-float arithmetic to the project end date.

THE PAIR

Pair: total float or free float. Total protects the end date; free protects the next activity.

> A portfolio board can fund only one of two projects. Project Alpha has an NPV of $120,000. Project Beta has an NPV of $80,000.
>
> The board chooses Alpha.

What is the opportunity cost of this decision?

A $0, since the better project was chosen.

B $120,000, the NPV of Alpha.

C $200,000, the combined NPV.

D $80,000, the NPV of Beta.

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What is the opportunity cost of this decision?

A $0.
Choosing well does not remove the value given up.

B $120,000.
That is the value gained, not the value forgone.

C $200,000.
Both values together; not a cost of anything.

D $80,000.
The value of the best option not chosen.

THE PAIR

Pair: sunk cost or opportunity cost. Opportunity cost is the value of the option you gave up.

> When the main supplier failed, the risk owner switched to the backup supplier, as the contingency plan required. Two weeks later, the backup supplier also fails to deliver.
>
> The risk register includes a further plan for this case: build the component in-house.

What should happen next?

A Implement the fallback plan, and build the component in-house.

B Try the contingency plan again with the backup supplier.

C Carry out a new risk analysis before acting.

D Escalate the failure to the sponsor.

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should happen next?

A Implement the fallback plan.
The contingency has failed; the fallback exists for exactly this.

B Retry the contingency.
It has already failed.

C New analysis.
The fallback was analysed and agreed in advance.

D Escalate.
A planned response exists within the owner's authority.

THE PAIR

Pair: contingency or fallback plan. When the contingency fails, the fallback applies.

> At recent sprint reviews, the team has spent most of the time discussing its internal disagreements about code reviews and pairing. Invited stakeholders say they leave without seeing much of the product.
>
> The scrum master wants to fix this.

What should the scrum master do?

A Stop inviting stakeholders to sprint reviews.

B Lengthen the sprint review to cover both topics.

C Move process discussions to the retrospective, and use the review to inspect the increment with stakeholders.

D Replace the retrospective with a longer review.

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should the scrum master do?

A Drop the stakeholders.

The review exists to get stakeholder feedback on the product.

B Lengthen the review.

Keeps mixing two events with different purposes and audiences.

C Process to the retrospective; product to the review.

Each event does its own job, with its own audience.

D Replace the retrospective.

Removes the team's safe space to improve its own way of working.

THE PAIR

Pair: sprint review or retrospective. Product with stakeholders; process within the team.

> A new project manager is listing the inputs available for planning a data centre move.
>
> Which of these is an organisational process asset?

Which item is an organisational process asset?

A. The shortage of qualified network engineers in the local labour market.

B. The organisation's lessons learned repository from past data centre moves.

C. A government regulation on data residency.

D. The organisation's risk-averse culture.

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

Which item is an organisational process asset?

A Labour market shortage.
An external condition: an environmental factor.

B Lessons learned repository.
The organisation's own knowledge, usable and updatable.

C Government regulation.
An external condition the project must work within.

D Risk-averse culture.
Internal, but a condition, not a usable asset. An environmental factor.

THE PAIR

Pair: process asset or environmental factor. Can you use and update it? Asset. Must you work within it? Factor.

When two options both look right, find the pair, then find the detail that decides it.

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